

followed by many subsequent decisions, allowing you to build the life you desire. This book was designed to be a guide to assist you on that journey, a choose-your-own-adventure book if you will. You can pick and choose the levers you want to pull as you design your personalized path to FI.

I started life heading down the standard path. I was conditioned from a young age to get “good grades” so I could go to a “good college.” Getting a degree would enable me to get a “good” (i.e., a high paying) job. This would allow me to live the American dream of owning a nice house in a good neighborhood, taking two to four weeks of vacation each year, and retiring at age sixty-five.

Shortly after starting my job as a physical therapist, I realized the career I had chosen, and the standard American professional lifestyle that accompanied it were not, in fact, what I wanted after all. Like many people, I felt trapped.

I spent seven years of my life and tens of thousands of dollars on degrees that enabled me to get what was supposed to be my “dream job.” My wife and I then bought our “dream house.” Unfortunately, we soon realized we were living someone else’s dream.